R&D | RetailPulse

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Interview and Portfolio Guide

In simple words

This document helps you present the project in interviews, on your resume and on GitHub. It has a 2-minute script, 15 questions with answer approaches, and resume lines.

1. Your project in 2 minutes (fill the blanks)

Script

I worked on a demand forecasting study for a grocery retail case. The business problem was that planners did not know where demand was hard to predict. I built a simple baseline in SQL, measured error using WAPE and Bias, and analysed it by product family, region, season and events. I found that **[N] families caused [Y]% of the error**, and that error rose around **[event or period]**. I built a 5-page Power BI dashboard and recommended **[main action]**. I also stated the limits: it is a simple baseline and the data has no cost, so I measured impact in units.

2. Interview questions and how to answer

Question	Answer approach
Tell me about this project	Use the 2-minute script.
What was the business problem?	Decision problem: where to add stock, where to cut orders.
How did you build the baseline?	Same weekday last week, plus a 4-week average. Window functions with exact date checks.
Why WAPE?	Works with zero sales, weights big sellers, easy to explain.
What is Bias and why show it?	Direction of the miss. WAPE alone hides if we are too high or too low.
How did you avoid double counting holidays?	Store-date flag table. Match National, Regional, Local. Remove transferred holidays.
How do you know your numbers are right?	Totals match across SQL and Power BI. Hand-checked one family.
What was the most important insight?	Your top Pareto finding and the action.
Did you find anything that surprised you?	A rejected hypothesis is a good answer.
How did you design the dashboard?	Story-first: headline titles, one message per chart, actions on the last page.
Which SQL techniques did you use?	CTEs, window functions, joins, CASE, date functions, views.
What are the limits?	Simple baseline, no cost, causes are likely not proven.
Is this a data scientist project?	No. I did not build models. I measured and explained where simple forecasts fail, and gave actions.
What would you do with more time?	Add cost data, event calendars, better baselines by family.
How would you explain WAPE to a manager?	Out of every 100 units sold, about [X] are the size of our miss.

3. Resume lines (replace brackets with your real results)

- Analysed [N] million daily sales rows in PostgreSQL to measure forecast error (WAPE, Bias) by family, region and season.
- Identified that [N] product families drive [Y]% of forecast error and recommended [action].

- Built a 5-page Power BI dashboard with headline insights and an actions page for supply chain managers.
- Wrote 12 SQL analyses with CTEs and window functions, and validated totals between SQL and Power BI.

Add a number only after you have it from your own results. Do not copy the brackets.

4. LinkedIn headline ideas

- Insights Analyst | SQL, Power BI, Excel | Turning data into business decisions
- M.Sc Mathematics | Aspiring Insights Analyst | SQL and Power BI projects

5. Portfolio plan

Project	Tools	What it shows
HR Job Change (Excel)	Excel	Cleaning, pivots, dashboard, business story
Demand Forecasting (this one)	PostgreSQL, Power BI	Advanced SQL, metrics, insights, actions
EduPulse	Power BI	Retention dashboard and recommendations

6. Red flags to avoid

- Calling the project 'forecasting model' or 'machine learning'. It is analysis.
- Showing a dashboard without saying what to do.
- Quoting numbers you cannot explain.
- Claiming money savings when there is no cost data.

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